

Weekend Audio Briefing — recording script

The South Knoxville Ear · Vol. 1 No. 9 · Thu–Sun, Aug 13–16, 2026

First person, in your own voice — a short neighborhood radio dispatch. Greeting stays time-of-day neutral. Target ≈ 2 min 40 sec (the TTS take ran 2:41).

SAY IT THIS WAY		
SoKno	SO-no	Two beats. Never “sock-no.”
Ijams	I'ms	ONE syllable — “times” without the T. Not “EYE-ams.”
Sevier	suh-VEER	Like the word “severe.”
Patrón	pa-TRONE	
Kern's	KURNS	

- 1 The smallest bird in East Tennessee gets a three-day party this weekend. Andy Roberts here with your South Knoxville Ear.
- 2 It's all at Ijams Park. Thursday and Friday nights only, eight enormous animated projections take over the woods along the Serendipity and Discovery Trails — it's called Communion, it's by Knoxville artist Lauren Strohacker, and you walk right through it, seeing hummingbirds the way almost nobody ever gets to. Timed entry between eight and ten, five dollars, and give yourself about an hour.
- 3 Then Saturday, the Hummingbird Festival takes the homesite from seven in the morning to one. Real banders, real birds, in twenty-five-minute sessions — and new this year, they're banding every bird they catch, not just the hummingbirds. Hummingbirds are busiest at first light, so the seven o'clock sessions are the ones you want. Twelve dollars for grown-ups, nine for kids five to twelve, under five free, and bird banding is a separate six-dollar ticket. There's also a marketplace with more than fifty artists.

- 4 One piece of neighborhood business, and it's a big one. Thursday at one-thirty, the plan for the old Kerbela Shriners temple — five and a half acres on Sevier Avenue at Dawson — goes before the Planning Commission as agenda item forty-four. It's a fifty-five-plus apartment community asking for relief from seven of the South Waterfront design standards. It's been postponed, revised, and heard twice already. The meeting's in the Main Assembly Room at the City County Building, it's open to the public, and you can request to speak through knoxplanning-dot-org.
- 5 A little bit of a goodbye, too: Mimosas, over on Blount, reopens August twenty-sixth as Puckers Sports Grill. The brunch dishes are staying on the menu — but if you've been meaning to go while it's still Mimosas, you've got two more weekends.
- 6 Sunday, the volume comes back down. The East Tennessee Bluegrass Association jam runs two to five on the plaza at Ijams Park — free, all skill levels, bring any acoustic instrument. No harmonicas, no spoons; they're firm about that. Storytellers take the trails at two as well, and Self Care Sunday yoga starts at eleven-thirty.
- 7 And elsewhere in the neighborhood: Saturday morning at ten-thirty, Kern's hosts All Play Live — a parents-versus-kids game show where the grown-ups have to actually play, and it's listed free. Friday night, it's Ted Lasso trivia at Hi-Wire on Barber Street. And Earl's out on the waterfront runs a different deal every day — ten-dollar Patrón ritas Thursday, nine-dollar spicy ritas Friday, eight-dollar margs all day Saturday, seven-dollar mimosas and Bloody Marys all day Sunday.
- 8 **That's the weekend. Keep your ears open — and I'll see you around SoKno!**